Operations Manager Review

Kolkata Dark Store Network | 01 Mar–28 Jun 2026

Executive summary. Stock-out pressure is concentrated rather than evenly distributed. New Town is the leading store-level problem, Dairy and Fresh Produce are the dominant categories, and the timing profile is strongest in the late evening. The lowest-stock-out stores provide internal benchmarks. The 208.26% utilization result should be treated as a data-quality or capacity-definition signal until validated.

Management Takeaways

• Prioritize New Town for root-cause review.

• Protect the 19:00–22:00 late-day window.

• Focus interventions on Dairy and Fresh Produce.

• Benchmark Alipore and Barasat.

• Validate the 208.26% utilization result before expansion decisions.

SQ1 — Highest-stock-out dark stores

New Town Dark Store (DS002) is the highest-burden store. It contributes approximately 26.58% of observed stock-outs at the inventory-snapshot grain. Stock-outs were observed across all 120 days, with strongest activity late in the day around 19:00–22:00.

SQ2 — Frequently affected SKUs

Mother Dairy Toned Milk 500ml, Apple Royal Gala 4 pcs and Green Chilli 100g are among the leading SKUs by cumulative stock-out duration. Green Chilli, Chaas and Apple Royal Gala are recurring examples across multiple days. Frequent replenishment requests are a pressure signal, not proof of delivery frequency.

SQ3 — Categories contributing most

Dairy and Fresh Produce dominate observed stock-out volume. Fresh Produce has the highest average duration (~9.5 h), followed closely by Dairy (~9.2 h).

SQ4 — Stores maintaining healthier inventory

Alipore (DS012) and Barasat (DS011) have the lowest observed stock-out levels and can serve as internal benchmarks. The overall below-reorder measure is 21.67%. Average recorded utilization is 208.26%, which requires validation before being used for expansion decisions.

Recommended Actions

1. Investigate New Town first: Review demand peaks, SKU mix, replenishment timing, supplier response and inventory positioning.

2. Protect the evening window: Test whether replenishment is completed before 19:00–22:00.

3. Create a chronic-SKU watchlist: Track high-duration and repeated-stock-out SKUs at store-SKU level.

4. Benchmark Alipore and Barasat: Compare reorder behavior and operating practices with high-stock-out stores.

5. Validate capacity data: Audit storage-capacity units and utilization definitions before expansion decisions.

Definitions & Caveats

• Inventory-snapshot stock-out counts are observations, not necessarily distinct events.

• Event-level counts use stockout_events and should not be mixed with snapshot-level totals.

• Analysis period: 01 Mar–28 Jun 2026 (120 days).

• Every-day stock-out presence means at least one observation occurred each day, not that every SKU/store stocked out daily.

• Causal claims require validation with demand, replenishment and supplier evidence.